THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 8 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 01

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 40 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one factual passage with 10 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one literary passage (poem or story) with 10 questions (1 mark each).
4. Write the question number before each answer.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Factual / Discursive Passage) 10 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

The Busy World of Honeybees

A honeybee colony is like a small, well-run town. In one hive live thousands of bees, and each of them has a job. The queen bee is the mother of the colony; her only task is to lay eggs, sometimes as many as a thousand in a single day. The male bees, called drones, mate with the queen. The vast majority of the hive are worker bees, all of them female, and it is they who keep the town running.

A young worker begins life as a cleaner, polishing the cells of the honeycomb. Later she becomes a nurse who feeds the grubs, then a builder who makes wax, and finally, in the last weeks of her life, a forager who flies out in search of flowers. A forager may visit several hundred flowers in a single trip, collecting sweet nectar in her stomach and yellow pollen on her legs.

When a forager finds a good patch of flowers, she returns to the hive and performs a special 'waggle dance'. The angle of the dance tells her sisters the direction of the flowers in relation to the sun, and the length of the waggle tells them how far to fly. It is one of the few examples in the animal world of an animal passing on exact directions to others.

Bees do far more than make honey. As they move from flower to flower, grains of pollen stick to their bodies and are carried to the next blossom. This is called pollination, and without it many fruits, vegetables and oilseeds would not grow. Scientists estimate that nearly one in every three mouthfuls of our food depends on pollinating insects. Sadly, the use of strong pesticides and the loss of wild flowers have reduced the number of bees in many places. Planting flowering shrubs in gardens and on balconies is a simple way in which every one of us can help these tiny workers.

(i) The queen bee's only task is to: 1

(a) make honey **(b)** collect pollen
(c) lay eggs **(d)** guard the hive

(ii) A worker bee becomes a forager: 1

(a) on the day she is born **(b)** in the last weeks of her life
(c) after she becomes queen **(d)** only in winter

(iii) The waggle dance tells other bees: 1

(a) where the queen is **(b)** the time of the day
(c) the direction and distance of flowers **(d)** the danger from birds

(iv) The word 'forager' in paragraph 2 means one who: 1

(a) cleans the hive **(b)** searches for food

(c) guards the entrance **(d)** builds a house

(v) The writer suggests that bees are in danger because of: 1

(a) lack of queens **(b)** pesticides and loss of wild flowers

(c) too many drones **(d)** too much rain

(vi) State whether True or False: All the worker bees are male. Correct the statement if false. 1

(vii) Name any two jobs a worker bee does during her life. 1

(viii) What is pollination? 1

(ix) What does 'they' refer to in 'it is they who keep the town running' (paragraph 1)? 1

(x) How can ordinary people help bees? 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Literary Passage — Poem / Story) — 10 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 10

The Lantern Seller

Each evening, when the market grows dim,
An old man arrives with his lanterns slim.
Red ones, green ones, blue and gold,
Swinging like stars that have grown too old.

He does not shout and he does not call;
He simply lights them, one and all.
Children gather and gaze in glee
At a rainbow hung on a bamboo tree.

"Why do you sell them," a small girl said,
"When the electric lamps shine bright overhead?"
He smiled and touched a paper wall,
"Because a flame is a living thing, that's all.

"The lamps in the street light up the road,
But a lantern warms the heart that's slowed
By a hurried day and its heavy load—
Take one, my child, and carry the glow away."

She walked back home with a lantern red,
And the dark seemed to bow its sleepy head.
The old man packed his bamboo tree,
Content with the light he had given for free.

(i) The old man arrives at the market: 1

(a) in the evening **(b)** at dawn

(c) at midnight **(d)** at noon

(ii) The lanterns are compared to: 1

(a) birds **(b)** balloons **(c)** stars **(d)** flowers

(iii) According to the old man, a lantern is special because: 1

(a) it never goes out **(b)** it is brighter than a bulb

(c) a flame is a living thing **(d)** it is very cheap

(iv) The line 'the dark seemed to bow its sleepy head' means that: 1

(a) it became more frightening **(b)** people went to sleep

(c) the lantern fell **(d)** the darkness seemed to lose its power

(v) The mood of the poem is: 1

(a) boastful
(b) angry
(c) warm and peaceful
(d) fearful

(vi) Name any two colours of the lanterns. 1

(vii) What did the children do when the lanterns were lit? 1

(viii) Why did the girl find it strange that the old man sold lanterns? 1

(ix) Pick out two rhyming words from the first stanza. 1

(x) How did the old man feel at the end? Which line tells you this? 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

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